



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Reduce Customer PM Cost
with Air Filter Cleaning
Service

Application Maintenance Site Management **Component Rebuild** Safety MARC Management

Reduce Customer PM Cost with Air Filter Cleaning Service0

1.0 Introduction1

2.0 Best Practice Description.....1

3.0 Implementation Steps2

4.0 Benefits.....3

5.0 Resources Required3

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References3

7.0 Related Best Practices3

8.0 Acknowledgements.....3

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1.0 Introduction

Fleets of Mining Off Highway Trucks working 24 hours a day, 365 day a year, consume up to 70 air filters per machine per year. Air Filters thus represent a significant preventative maintenance cost. Some dealers have invested in high technology air filter cleaning equipment and offer a filter cleaning service to their customers. There are many suppliers for air filters and the business is very price competitive. A filter cleaning service creates an advantage that most competitive filter suppliers do not offer and can play a major role in capturing air filter sales business.

Cleaning and re-using air filters up to 10 times is especially effective in controlling costs of Maintenance and Repair Contracts, Customer Support Agreements, and Rental fleets and helps to lower customer PM costs.

2.0 Best Practice Description

Dealers who provide a filter cleaning service usually do so with a “filter exchange” program. Customer returns a dirty filter with no visible damage and receives a cleaned filter. There is a flat rate charge approximately equal to 25% of the cost of a new filter. I

Data from dealers who provide filter cleaning service report that air filter can be effectively cleaned between 3 and 10 times before they can no longer be reused. Life of the cleaned filters is close to 90% of the life of a new filter and air filtration is equal to that of a new filter.

Caterpillar no longer provides air filter cleaning equipment. The preferred equipment for air filter cleaning is the Sonic Dry Clean Air Filter Cleaning System. The system is a sonic vibration and synchronized air injection cleaning booth with dust collection system and inspection lighting. Other required equipment includes a filter dryer, air compressor, filter track, racks, and a dust collection and disposal.



Filter Track – feed to cleaner



Filter Drying Booth

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2/19/2015

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Air Filter Cleaner and Filter track



Filter Storage and Packaging

3.0 Implementation Steps

- Assess business opportunity. Important points include:
 - o Customer acceptance
 - o Potential filter sales growth
 - o Volume
 - o Impact on MARCs, CSAs, and Rental maintenance costs.
 - o Competition
- Caterpillar no longer offers air filter cleaning equipment. Dealers performing an air filter cleaning service are utilizing Sonic Dry Clean as the equipment supplier.
- Determine number of cleaning machines required for expected volume and number of working shifts. Approximate floor space required is 80 square meters per cleaning machine.
- Identify facility space.

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- Get quotation for equipment and training from supplier. Approximately US \$80,000 per cleaner.
- Perform return on investment analysis
- Develop market plan.
- Acquire and train personnel.
- Install equipment (6 – 8 weeks)
- Develop filter tracking process – bar code or stickers to document number of times filter has been cleaning and reused.

4.0 Benefits

- Lowers customer PM costs
- Captures air filter business
- Can be used to service competitive machines and capture incremental business
- Environmental – recycle air filters

5.0 Resources Required

- Floor space – 80 square meters or more for multiple air cleaning stations
- Cleaning equipment – approximately US \$80,000 per cleaner.
- Personnel

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

None.

7.0 Related Best Practices

None.

8.0 Acknowledgements

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